



KAZAKHS

THE SECOND LARGEST MUSLIM GROUP in Central Asia, the Kazakhs live not only in Kazakhstan but also in China, Uzbekistan, Russia, and Mongolia. Like others in the region, their traditional occupation used

ROAMING THE STEPPES OF CENTRAL ASIA

A round house

A domed wooden frame covered with felt forms the basis for a *yurt*. At the entrance to the *yurt* is a carved wooden door of birch or pine, often decorated with traditional motifs. Inside there is a gap in the *yurt's* roof where smoke from cooking can escape. Scattered everywhere are brightly colored rugs made of wool and felt.



TRAVELING LIGHT

Yurts vary in size, but they are all built to the same basic design that uses about 60 interlocking poles and one or two layers of waterproof felt. They are quick and easy to dismantle and transport by horse or camel.



Yurt-dwellers love having guests. A Kazakh saying claims "Kazaks' hearts are like the steppes—wide, kind, and generous."